

SOUTH AFRICA

◆ Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of South Africa
Short Form	South Africa
Capital	Pretoria (administrative), Bloemfontein (judicial), Cape Town (legislative)
Region (UN)	Africa
Government Type	Parliamentary republic
Head of State	Cyril Ramaphosa, President
Head of Government	Cyril Ramaphosa, President
Currency	South African Rand (ZAR)
UN Member Since	1945 (re-admitted in 1994 after apartheid)
MUN Standing	Influential Global South voice; prominent in BRICS, peacekeeping, and African diplomacy. Often acts as a bridge between developed and developing nations.

📖 General Book Recommendations

1. "Foreign Policy in Post-Apartheid South Africa" – John Siko
2. "South Africa and the United Nations" – Peter Vale
3. "BRICS and Africa: Emerging Markets and South-South Cooperation" – Francis Kornegay & Narnia Bohler-Muller
4. "The Diplomacy of Liberation: The Foreign Relations of the ANC Since 1960" – Scott Thomas
5. "South Africa's Multilateral Diplomacy and Global Change" – Maxi Schoeman

Source Name	Link
UN Women South Africa Multi-Country Office (SAMCO)	https://africa.unwomen.org/en/where-we-are/eastern-and-southern-africa/south-africa-mco
UN Women Representative in South Africa Multi-Country Office	https://africa.unwomen.org/en/where-we-are/eastern-and-southern-africa/south-africa-multi-country-office/samco-repr
South Africa's Commitment to UN Women	https://www.unwomen.org/en/get-involved/step-it-up/commitments/south-africa

South Africa's Beijing+25 National Review	https://www.unwomen.org/sites/default/files/Headquarters/Attachments/Sections/CSW/64/National-reviews/South%20Af
South Africa's Beijing+30 National Review	https://africa.unwomen.org/sites/default/files/2024-09/b30_report_south_africa_en_0.pdf
UN Women Transparency Portal: South Africa	https://open.unwomen.org/en/country-results/ZA
UN Women Data Hub: South Africa Country Fact Sheet	https://data.unwomen.org/country/south-africa
UN Women Africa Regional Office	https://africa.unwomen.org/en
UN Women Africa – In Focus: CSW65	https://africa.unwomen.org/en/news-and-events/in-focus/csw
UN Women Africa – Where We Are: Eastern and Southern Africa	https://africa.unwomen.org/en/where-we-are/eastern-and-southern-africa_africa
UN Women Africa – Where We Are: Africa	http://southafrica.unwomen.org/
UN Women Africa – Commission on the Status of Women	https://www.un.org/womenwatch/daw/csw/csw97.htm

South Africa's Report on Implementation of Agreed Conclusions on Women's Economic Empowerment	https://www.unwomen.org/sites/default/files/Headquarters/Attachments/Sections/CSW/65/MS%20Inputs%20Review%202022.pdf
Transforming Equality: UN Women in Eastern and Southern Africa	https://www.unwomen.org/en/digital-library/publications/2016/6/transforming-equality-un-women-in-eastern-and-southern-africa
UN Women East and Southern Africa Regional Office At A Glance	https://africa.unwomen.org/en/digital-library/publications/2022/09/un-women-east-and-southern-africa-regional-office-at-a-glance
Participants in the Africa Beijing+25 Review	https://www.unwomen.org/en/news/stories/2019/11/news-africa-regional-review-of-beijing25
CSW64 / Beijing+25: Preparations	https://www.unwomen.org/en/csw/csw64-2020/preparations

Unique Aspect	Explanation
Constitutional Commitment to Gender Equality	South Africa's Constitution clearly states that discrimination based on gender is not allowed, laying a solid legal groundwork for efforts aimed at achieving gender equality.
Women Empowerment and Gender Equality Bill (WEGE)	Since its enactment in 2014, this bill requires that women make up 50% of decision-making roles in both public and private sectors.
High Female Parliamentary Representation	As of February 2024, women make up 46% of the seats in South Africa's parliament, showcasing a remarkable step forward in achieving gender equality in politics.
Comprehensive Gender-Based Violence Legislation	South Africa has put in place strong laws aimed at tackling gender-based violence, such as the Criminal Law (Sexual Offences and Related Matters) Amendment Act.
Active Participation in UNCSW Sessions	South Africa is a regular contributor to UNCSW sessions, where it shares its best practices and works to align its national policies with global gender equality goals.
Focus on Women's Economic Empowerment	Programs are designed to boost women's involvement in the economy, offering support for female entrepreneurs and improving access to financial resources.
Implementation of Beijing Platform for Action	South Africa has carried out thorough national reviews, known as Beijing+25 and Beijing+30, to evaluate its progress and outline future goals for achieving gender equality.
Integration of Traditional Practices	Efforts are made to reconcile traditional practices with gender equality principles, promoting cultural sensitivity in gender

	initiatives.
Commitment to Transparency and Accountability	South Africa is proudly demonstrating its commitment to transparent and effective gender equality initiatives through platforms like the UN Women Transparency Portal.
Regional Leadership in Gender Equality	South Africa is at the forefront of promoting gender equality in the region, working hand in hand with its neighboring countries through the UN Women Multi-Country Office.

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